PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS
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2014-2016 Strategic Plan

1. Build a Financially Sustainable Organization

- *Ensuring that Partners remains strong and influential is our top priority.*
- *We all must make the necessary effort and time investment into sustaining Partners mission and strengthening our capacity to be financially independent.*
- *The goal here is to "hold and expand" our core activities in areas such as Youth Engagement and in programs like A Ganar, Farmer to Farmer and the various professional leadership exchanges that we manage with the Department of State.*
- *At the same time, all must put a renewed emphasis on putting the infrastructure in place that will allow Partners to capitalize on new opportunities and develop unsolicited proposals in which we can champion new ideas that leverage the talent of our growing network of volunteers and affiliated institutions.*

2. Strengthen Our Network

- *The core strength of Partners has always been its ability to connect individuals and organizations across the hemisphere and amass a network that is greater than the sum of its parts.*
- *Today we are creating a revitalized network of volunteers, civil society organizations, businesses, universities, governments and collaborators of all forms.*
- *We need to place renewed emphasis on learning and educating ourselves about the many ways to position Partners.*
- *We are in a new era and need to be learning-ready, proactive, and able to make connections and collaborate meaningfully across program areas.*

3. Create an Accountable and Transparent Organization

- *Partners must continually nurture its relationship with donors, grant-writers and all those who support our mission.*
- *To inspire trust and confidence in our operations, it is imperative that Partners create a climate of transparency and accountability, in which contributors can freely access financial and programmatic information.*
- *Through clean audits, an efficient governance structure, on-time submissions of quarterly and annual reports, improving donor communication, and attaining BBB certification, Partners will be able to ensure supporters that their contributions are wisely invested and buttress our reputation among competitors and members alike.*

4. Evaluate and Communicate Our Impact and Value

- *Consistent and compelling communication under a unified brand is crucial for increasing visibility, building strategic partnerships, and providing value to Partners' network.*
- *Identifying opportunities to highlight the unique work of Partners through diverse communication outlets (i.e., success stories, case studies, one-pagers, info graphics, photos, videos, etc.) is essential for informing and inspiring stakeholders, growing our network, and elevating our brand.*
- *Ensuring our programs and projects achieve measurable results, and improving our capacity to aggregate these results to represent organization-wide impact, will improve our image as a technically sound organization.*

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2015 President's Goals

Build a Financially Sustainable Organization

- $15.3M Operating Budget ($12.5 Revenue, $2.9 Admin)
- Maintain NICRA at 25%
- Raise $400,000 UNR
- Eliminate deficit (cut by $150K)
- Raise $1.5M for 2016 to maintain or expand operating budget
- Secure $1.2M IDB reimbursement
- Raise $3M from Private/ Foundation sources for 100kstrong

Strengthen Partners Network

- 100% of all existing organizations and individuals who receive benefits from Partners are registered on PartnersConnect (board resolutions)
- Support Network 50th Anniversary Celebrations including the *2015 What Works!* Conference
- Oversee planning of 2016 Guadalajara Convention
- Establish the initial 3 agreements with leadership institutes to create the PartnersLeadership Network.
- Ensure that program curricula are completed for YouthLead, A Ganar, and Volunteer Leadership.

Maintain a well governed, accountable and transparent organization

- Execute 5 board meetings, 2 board elections and train to new members
- Increase staff cross-training, planning and meeting time…follow-up to All-Staff Retreat
- Plan 2016 All-staff in the field with the total staff of all programs.
- Manage risk and avoid personnel or program legal exposure (i.e. Clean Audits)

Evaluate & Communicate Partners' Impact & Value

- Refine & Execute President's Communications Plan
- Host DC Based 50th Anniversary Spinoff event with former staff and key network stakeholders.
- Insure Partners' highest visibility at the Summit of the Americas
- Disseminate 50th Anniversary Books
- Insure 100,000 Strong Hemispheric workshop.
- Implement Agency-wide "SalesForce" system
- Write the forward to "Building Food Security and Nutrition Network in the Americas"
- Create Partners' Network Atlas

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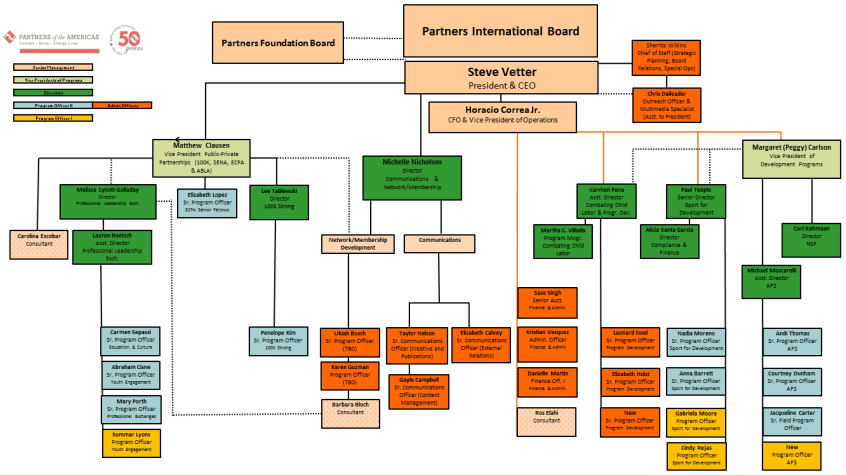
Team of Teams

NEW 2015 Org Chart



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Strategic Leadership Committees

- All-Staff Meeting (Monthly – 1st Week)
- Senior Exec. Committee (Monthly – 3rd Week)
- President's Council (Monthly – 4th Week)
- IT Committee (Weekly)
- Network/Membership Committee (Weekly)

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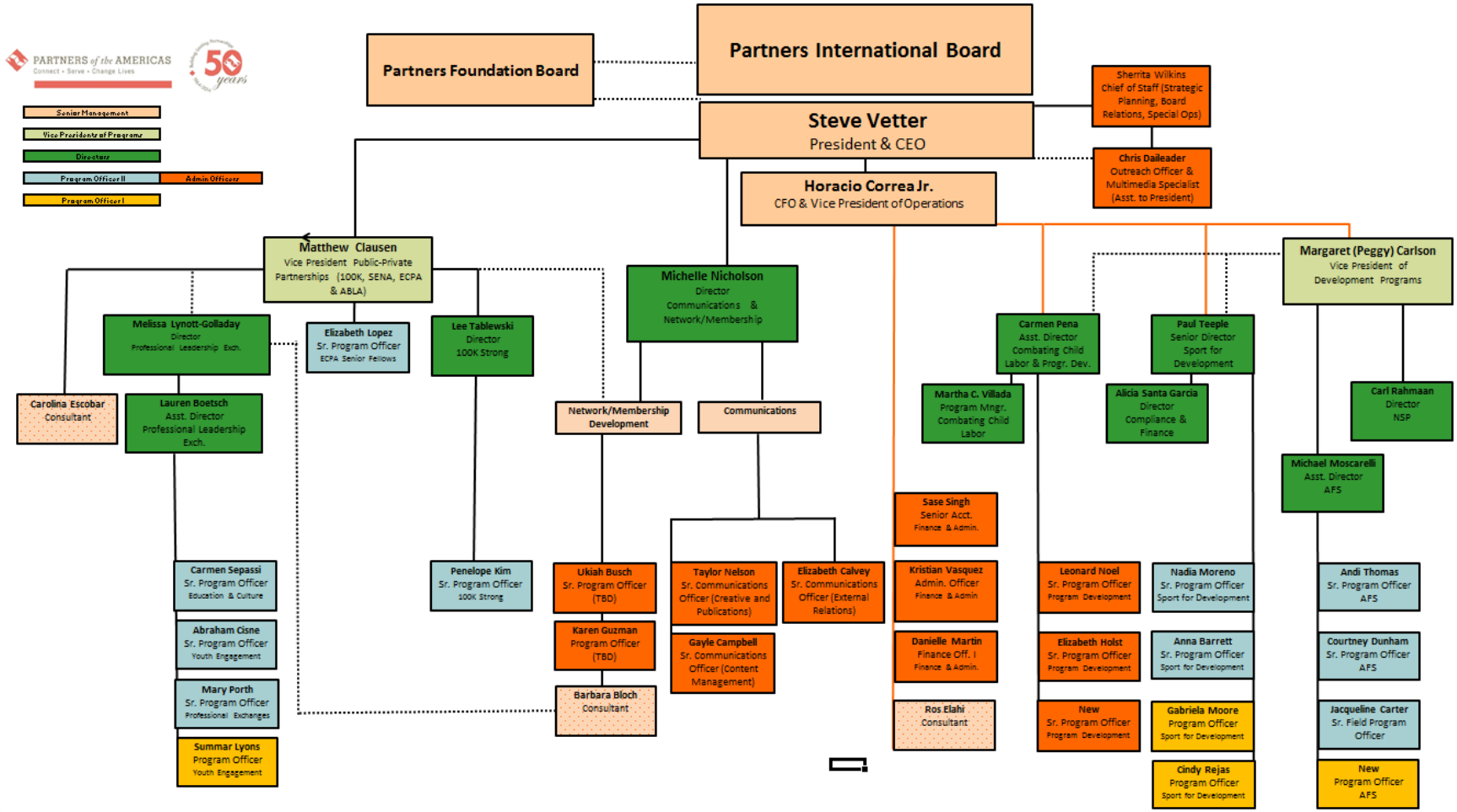
Building Lasting Partnerships 50 years 1964-2014

NEW 2015 Organizational Chart



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2015 Strategic Leadership Committees & Special Staff Meetings

All-Staff Meeting
(Monthly – 1st Week)

Senior Exec. Committee
(Monthly – 4th Week)

President's Council
(Monthly – 3rd Week)

IT Committee
(Weekly)

Network/Membership Committee
(Weekly)

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Monthly All-Staff Meeting

Function:
The all-staff meeting is primarily for information sharing across Partners' staff. The expectation is that each office within the organization present a brief update on relevant business travel, key meetings/events, partnership and program opportunities and needs for support. While questions and open discussion are welcome, these meetings are not designed to be strategy sessions.

Chair:
Sherrita Wilkins, Chief of Staff

- responsible for setting the meeting schedule and agenda.

Standing Members:
DC Staff and Interns

Meeting Schedule:

- July 6th
- August 3rd
- September 1st
- October 5th
- November 2nd
- December 7th

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President's Council

Function:

This committee meets monthly (typically the 3rd week) or at the discretion of the President to discuss issues of overall organizational importance. As there will now be internal forums for both IT and Membership/ Network, this space can be reserved for financial, planning, strategic, or other conversations that require the input and participation of senior staff. This committee is NOT an IT decisi on making body but it can provide recommendations that factor into IT and or membership/ network related c oncerns.

Chair:

Steve Vetter, President & CEO

- Works in coordination with senior leadership and the Chief of Staff to set the meeting's schedule and agenda.

Standing Members:

Program/Unit Directors, VPs and Senior Management

(Peggy Carlson, Matt Clausen, Horacio Correa, Melissa Golloday, Michelle Nicholson, Carmen Peña, Alicia Santa, Sherrita Wilkins, Steve Vetter)

Meeting Schedule:

- June 22th
- July 20th
- August 17th
- September 14th
- October 19th
- November 16th
- December 14th

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IT Committee

Function:
This committee' shares expertise on IT and technology issues within Partners. The purpose of the committee is to provide recommendations to Sr. Mgmt. and the Communications Director as to how to start, close, implement, or otherwise proceed with technology related items. This includes the website, databases, membership platforms, software, and other systems used or to be used by Partners staff. This is NOT a decision making body. It IS an advisory and feedback body. Decisions on tech matters are the sole responsibility of Sr. Mgmt. in consultation with Michelle

Chair:
Horacio Correa, CFO & VP of Operations

- ❑ responsible for setting the meeting's schedule and agenda.

Standing Members:
Ukiah Busch, Liz Calvey, Peggy Carlson, Horacio Correa, Michelle Nicholson, (Steve Vetter as needed)

Meeting Schedule:

- ❑ Weekly

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Network/Membership Committee

Function:
This committee provide feedback around membership and network issues. This would give programs and units a place to air concerns regarding how membership and network impact their programs or areas of responsibility. All staff are welcome to participate in the membership and network taskforce, but participation will be especially important for staff serving as POC's. The membership and network taskforce will NOT be the location for having technology conversations around membership—that will happen in the IT Working group, allowing this committee to focus exclusively on issues such as value propositions, benefits to membership, issues within the network, processes such as rechartering, intersections between programs and the network, etc.

**The roles and responsibilities of POCs will be shared separately.*

Chair:
Michelle Nicholson, Director of Communications & Network/Membership

- ❑ responsible for setting the meeting's schedule and agenda.

Standing Members:
Everyone in the newly combined Communications & Network/Membership Unit + Staff POCs
(Horacio Correa and Steve Vetter will participate as needed)

Meeting Schedule:

- ❑ Weekly

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Senior Executive Committee

Function:
This meeting is designed to be a "prep session" for the all staff meeting as well as oversee large policy and procedural issues (i.e. budget, performance reviews, board issues etc.)

Chair:
Steve Vetter, President & CEO

- Works in coordination with senior leadership and the Chief of Staff to set the meeting's schedule and agenda.

Standing Members:
Peggy Carlson, Matt Clausen, Horacio Correa, Sherrita Wilkins, Steve Vetter

Meeting Schedule:

- July 27th
- August 24th
- September 28th
- October 26th
- November 30th
- December 18th

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NEW 2015 Organizational Structure & Midyear Goals Review Process

Date	Activity	Lead(s)
June 4	Announce 2015 NEW Organizational Structure to DC Staff (begin feedback and adoption process)	Steve
June 9 - 19	Send feedback to Program/Units on 2015 Goals & schedule meetings with Program/Unit Directors to review organizational priorities and provide in-person feedback on goals.	Sherrita
June 22	Hold President's Council Meeting to Share and Review Revised Mid-year Goals (team by team)	President's Council
June 30	Each Team Submits Final 2015 Goals. Begin Lifting Core 2015 Goals and Organizational Priorities into a Draft 2016-2018 Strategic Plan	Each Program/Unit
July 7	Special Meeting of the Senior Executive Committee to Review & Finalize 2015 Corporate Goals for Submission to the Board.	Senior Exec Committee
July 9	Send Corporate Goals and Draft Strategic Plan to Boards	Sherrita
July 23	*Tentative:* Joint International & Foundation Board Meeting	Sherrita